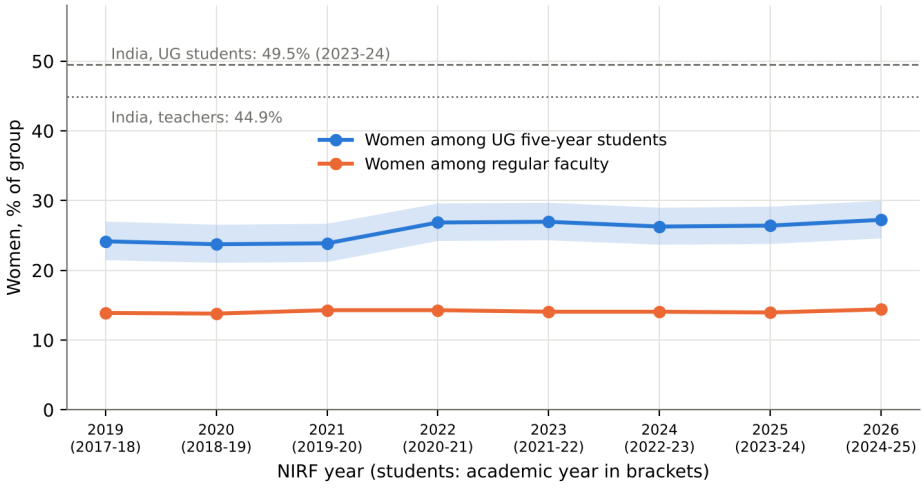
IISER Kolkata: what the NIRF data show, 2017-18 to 2024-25

Short summary report · iGEM IISER Kolkata 2026 · Inclusivity

In brief

- **Women are a stable minority.** They are 27.2% of UG five-year students (2024-25), up from 24.2% in 2017-18, and 14.4% of regular faculty (18 of 125). The student share is about half India's 49.5% for UG students, and the faculty share about a third of India's 44.9% for teachers.
- **The student share rose once, then stopped.** It stepped from 23.9% to 26.9% in 2020-21 and has stayed between 26.3% and 27.2% since.
- **Faculty hiring has stalled, and so has the share of women.** Regular faculty grew from 108 to 126 between 2019 and 2021 and have stayed near 125 to 129 since. The count of women has been 18 in every list since 2021, and their share has stayed between 13.8% and 14.4%.
- **SC, ST and OBC students are about 47% and flat.** The share is close to the 49.5% reference and has not trended (range 43.8% to 47.5%).
- **More students now come from West Bengal.** The share rose from 34.6% to 42.6% of UG and PG students.
- **At the junior end of the faculty the numbers are very small.** Only 18 of 125 regular faculty are assistant professors, and 3 of them are women.

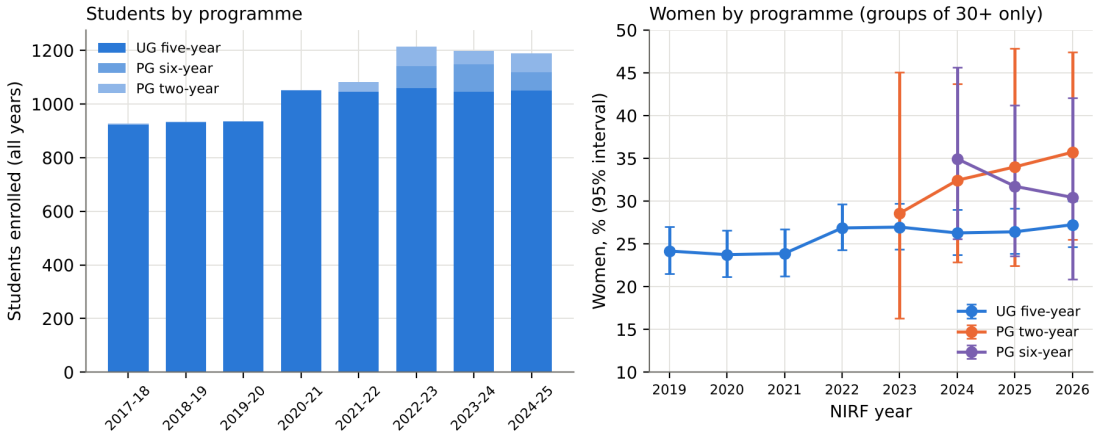
Women among students and faculty



Women among UG five-year students (with 95% interval) and among regular faculty, 2019 to 2026. Source: NIRF.

The gap between students and faculty has been about 10 to 13 percentage points throughout. The student line is the share of all students enrolled in the five-year programme, across its five years, so it moves slowly: a year's new entrants can differ from the group as a whole.

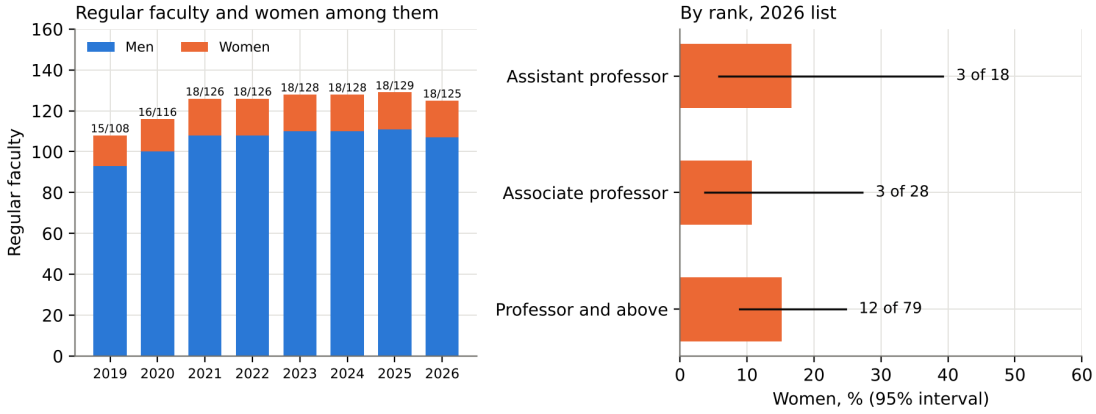
Between 2019 and 2026 the faculty grew by 17 people, 3 women and 14 men. Women were 18% of that growth, a little above their starting share of 13.9%, so the overall share barely moved.



Left: students enrolled by programme. Right: women's share by programme, for groups of 30 or more. Source: NIRF.

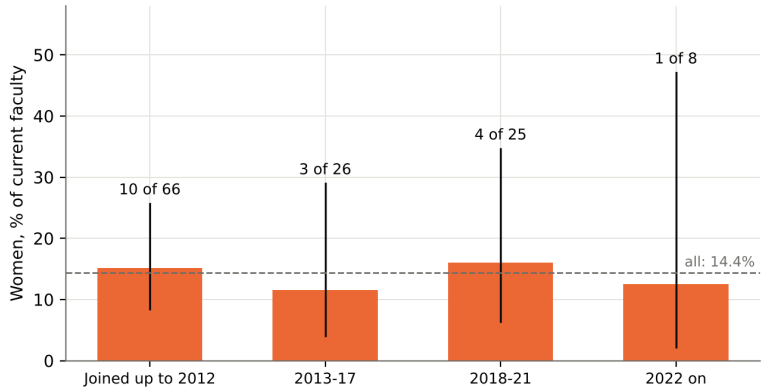
UG five-year students are the large majority, about 1,050 in each recent year. Postgraduate programmes appear from 2021-22 and reach 139 students in 2024-25 (70 two-year and 69 six-year). Women's share in the two-year programme has risen from 28.6% to 35.7% and in the six-year programme has been 30% to 35%, but each group is under 110 students, so the intervals are wide and we cannot call these trends.

Women among faculty



Left: regular faculty and women among them, by NIRF year. Right: women by rank, 2026 list, with 95% intervals. Source: NIRF faculty lists.

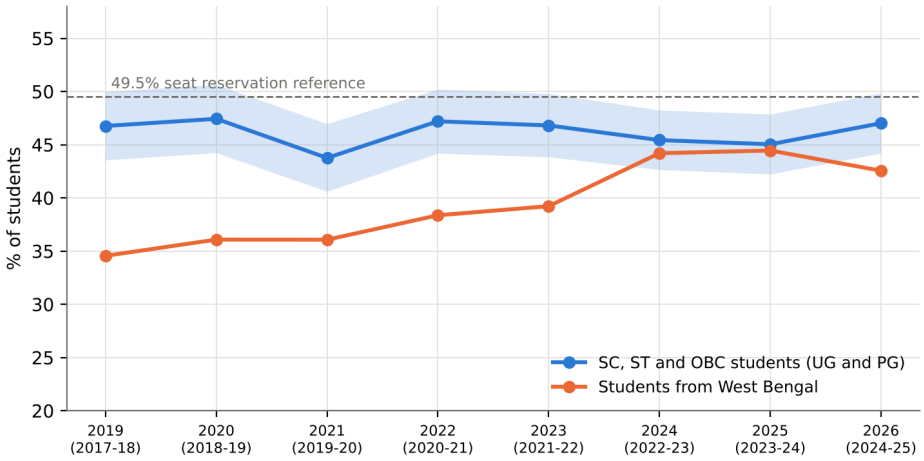
By rank, women are 3 of 18 assistant professors (17%), 3 of 28 associate professors (11%) and 12 of 79 professors and above (15%). The intervals overlap, so we cannot say that any rank is different from another. The notable fact is the small number of junior posts: 18 assistant professors in all.



Women among current regular faculty, by period of joining. Source: NIRF faculty lists.

Looking at the date each person joined, women are 10 of 66 (15%) of those who joined up to 2012, 3 of 26 (12%) in 2013-17, 4 of 25 (16%) in 2018-21 and 1 of 8 (12.5%) from 2022. These shares do not rise, unlike the pooled figure across the seven IISERs, but with 8 to 66 people per group the intervals are very wide, and we can only see people who are still here.

SC, ST and OBC, and home state



SC, ST and OBC share of UG and PG students (with 95% interval) and share from West Bengal. Source: NIRF.

The SC, ST and OBC share has stayed in a narrow band, 43.8% to 47.5%, and the 49.5% reference line is within the interval in most years. NIRF reports these three groups together, so the figure cannot separate SC and ST students. The share of students from West Bengal has risen by about eight points since 2017-18, with a peak of 44.5% in 2023-24.

Factors to keep in mind

- Student figures **count everyone** enrolled, so they cannot show the mix of a single year's entrants.
- Institutes **self report** the data for NIRF. Male plus female equals the total in every row, and our faculty counts match a separate count of each PDF.
- **Regular faculty** are those listed as currently working with association type "Regular". Where the list marks the director as such, he is counted.
- **Gender** is recorded as male or female only.
- **Years.** NIRF year Y describes students in academic year (Y-2) to (Y-1), so NIRF 2026 is 2024-25. Faculty lists are snapshots in year Y.

Source: NIRF "Overall" submissions of IISER Kolkata, 2019 to 2026 (eight files), tables "Total Actual Student Strength" and "Faculty Details". India comparisons: AISHE 2023-24.